

Mattia Galante

Environmental economics and valuation

Education

University of Trento — 2024 – present

PhD in Sustainability: Economics, Environment, Management & Society (SUSTEEMS)

Thesis: Economic valuation of marine ecosystems: applications, developments and challenges
Supervisors: Prof. Silvia Ferrini, Prof. Carlo Fezzi

University of Siena — 2020 – 2023

Master's Degree in Environmental Economics and Sustainability

Thesis: Consumers' attitudes towards sustainability of finfish products within the European market: a meta-regression analysis of discrete choice experiments
Final grade: 110/110 cum laude

University of Naples "Federico II" — 2015 – 2020

Bachelor's Degree in Political Sciences

Thesis: Degrowth and criticism to development
Final grade: 110/110 cum laude

Visiting and research experience

EDHEC Business School, Nice (France) — Apr – May 2026

Visiting PhD student

Description: Data Science, Economics & Finance, Nice campus, from 13 April to 25 May 2026.

CoNISMa (Italian Inter-University Consortium of Marine Sciences) — 2023 – 2024

Research collaborator

Description: Collaboration in the research activities of OCEAN CITIZEN, a project co-funded by the European Union that develops a multidisciplinary approach to the restoration of marine ecosystems. Tasks: methodological reviews; design and implementation of a framework to identify relevant stakeholders; and, mainly, economic valuation of ecosystem services with natural capital accounting methods and with revealed and stated preferences.

Norwegian University of Science and Technology (NTNU) — 2022

Erasmus Programme

Description: Four-month exchange during which I took courses and carried out research for my Master's thesis, working on issues related to marine resources and the fish market.

Research

Under review

Corals that count: Valuing carbon stocks and biomass cumulation in a Floating Reef Device
With G. Giallongo, S. Ferrini, N. Shashar, B. Rinkevich

Consumer preferences for finfish attributes in Europe: A meta-regression of stated-choice evidence and implications for policy
With G. Grilli, J. Cantillo, S. Ferrini

Working papers

Cost vector effects and familiarity in discrete choice experiments
With C. Fezzi, S. Notaro, S. Ferrini · presented at WCERE 2026, the 14th IAERE Annual Conference (2026) and the 193rd EAAE–EAERE Seminar (2025)

About me

I am a PhD student in SUSTEEMS at the University of Trento, working on environmental valuation. I use stated preference methods — discrete choice experiments and contingent valuation — to study how people value ecosystems, with a special focus on marine and coastal ones. My current work addresses the methodological challenges and behavioural biases of these methods, and develops new models and applications built on a basket-based approach.

My work sits where environmental and behavioural economics meet: how the design of a valuation survey (cost vectors, incentives, payment formats) shapes the willingness-to-pay estimates it produces. Part of my research also focuses on cost-benefit analysis and on causal inference about the effects of climate change.

Research interests

- Economic valuation of ecosystem services
- Stated preference methods (DCE, CVM, BEBCE)
- Choice modelling
- Behavioural biases in valuation
- Consumers' preferences in sustainable markets
- Cost-benefit analysis
- Causal inference on climate change effects

Languages

- **Italian:** mother tongue
- **English:** C1 (Cambridge CAE)
- **French:** B2 (DELF B2)

Software

- **Data processing:** R (Apollo, tidyverse), MATLAB, Simulink, Excel
- **Programming:** VBA, Python
- **Surveys:** Qualtrics, Prolific
- **Word processing:** LaTeX

Projects

MARBEFES — Horizon Europe, GA 101060937

Stated-preference survey on the ecosystem services of the Gulf of Gdańsk, with the Institute of Oceanology of the Polish Academy of Sciences

OCEAN CITIZEN — Horizon Europe, GA 101093910

Economic valuation of ecosystem services and of the impact of marine restoration activities

Conferences and seminars

WCERE 2026 — 7th World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists, Carcavelos–Cascais (Portugal) — Jun – Jul 2026

Paper: *Cost vector effects and familiarity in discrete choice experiments*

14th IAERE Annual Conference, Trento (Italy) — Feb 2026

Paper: *Cost vector effects and familiarity in discrete choice experiments*

193rd EAAE Seminar (1st joint EAAE–EAERE seminar): *Valuation Methods in Agro-food and Environmental Economics. What's next?*, Castelldefels (Spain) — Dec 2025

Paper: *Cost vector effects and familiarity in discrete choice experiments*

SPUDM 2025 — Subjective Probability, Utility and Decision Making (EADM), IMT Lucca (Italy) — 2025

Paper: *Trends in European Finfish Consumption: Evidences from a Meta-Regression Analysis and Implications for Sustainability*

Summer schools

ECOBAS & EAERE, Santiago de Compostela (Spain) — Jun 2026

ECOBAS–EAERE Summer School 2026: Recent Applications of AI in Environmental and Resource Economics

Description: 32-hour programme organised by the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE) and the ECOBAS Interuniversity Research Center, 6–12 June 2026.

OGS (National Institute of Oceanography and Applied Geophysics) — 2023

Summer School in Sustainable Blue Economy

Description: Transformative pathways to sustainability in the Blue Economy in the Mediterranean: multidisciplinary topics related to the marine and maritime sectors, with theoretical insights, practical applications and technological trends.

Teaching

Tutor — Lab I: Market Analysis — 2026/27

Degree programme in Economics and Management, University of Trento

Tutor — R statistical software — 2025/26

Both semesters · Department of Economics and Management, University of Trento

Awards

Symbola Prize "10 Thesis for Sustainability" — 2023

Top 100 Master's theses

Description: Awarded to the top 100 Italian Master's theses addressing contemporary sustainability issues.

Service and memberships

Member, A3EL — Applied Environmental and Energy Economics Lab, University of Trento

Member, Council of Doctoral Students and Holders of Research Contracts, University of Trento

Member of EAERE (European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists) and IAERE (Italian Association of Environmental and Resource Economists)